

Document owner: Joseph O'Sullivan, Managing Director

Version: 1.0

Effective date: 26 August 2026

Next review date: 26 August 2027

Approval status: Approved

Simtec Consult Limited is committed to providing an inclusive working environment and equal opportunities in employment and business relationships. We value difference, make decisions fairly and do not tolerate unlawful discrimination, harassment, victimisation or bullying.

1. SCOPE AND LEGAL FRAMEWORK

This policy applies to directors, employees, workers, applicants, consultants, contractors and others working with Simtec. It covers recruitment, pay, benefits, development, allocation of work, performance, promotion, conduct, termination and dealings with customers and suppliers. It supports compliance with the Equality Act 2010.

2. PROTECTED CHARACTERISTICS

Simtec will not unlawfully discriminate because of age, disability, gender reassignment, marriage or civil partnership, pregnancy or maternity, race (including colour, nationality and ethnic or national origin), religion or belief, sex or sexual orientation. We also seek to avoid unfair treatment arising from working pattern, caring responsibilities, socio-economic background or other irrelevant factors.

3. OUR COMMITMENTS

Simtec will:

- make employment and contracting decisions using objective, role-relevant criteria;
- use inclusive language and avoid unnecessary barriers in recruitment and work allocation;
- consider and implement reasonable adjustments for disabled people and those with physical or mental health conditions;
- provide fair access to information, support, development and progression;
- maintain a working environment free from harassment, sexual harassment, bullying and victimisation;
- address concerns promptly and protect people from retaliation for raising them.

4. REMOTE WORKING AND ACCESSIBILITY

Because Simtec operates predominantly remotely, managers must consider accessibility of digital tools, meetings, communications and home-working arrangements. Adjustments may include changes to equipment, software, communication methods, hours, workload, duties, meeting formats or travel requirements, subject to individual need and reasonableness.

5. RESPONSIBILITIES AND CONDUCT

The Managing Director has overall responsibility for this policy. Managers must apply it consistently, consider adjustments and respond to concerns. Everyone covered by the policy must treat others with dignity and respect and must not encourage, participate in or ignore discriminatory conduct.

6. RAISING CONCERNS

Employees should raise employment concerns with the Managing Director using the appropriate grievance or informal resolution route. Serious wrongdoing or systemic breaches may be reported under the Whistleblowing Policy. Contractors and applicants may raise concerns directly with the Managing Director. Complaints will be handled fairly, sensitively and as confidentially as practicable.

7. MONITORING AND REVIEW

Simtec will review recruitment, complaints, adjustments and other relevant information proportionately to identify barriers or recurring issues. Personal information will be handled in accordance with data protection requirements. This policy will be communicated at induction and reviewed at least annually.

APPROVAL

Approved by: Joseph O'Sullivan, Managing Director

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to be 'J. O'Sullivan', with a large loop at the start and several horizontal strokes at the end.

Signature:

Date: 26 August 2026